

Galbula ruficauda

Rufous-tailed jacamar



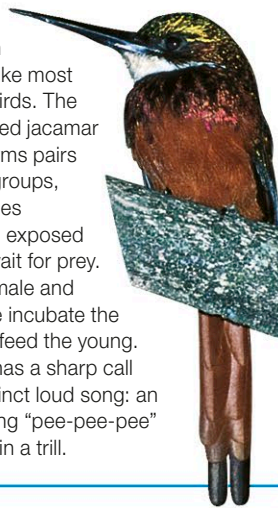
Location S. Central America, N.W. and C. South America

Length 10 in (25 cm)
Weight 7/16 oz (25 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern



Found only in Central and South America, jacamars are a family of 18 species of brilliantly colored, iridescent birds that feed on large insects, catching most of their prey in midair. Their diet includes butterflies, bees, winged ants, and dragonflies. The rufous-tailed

jacamar has a metallic golden-green head and upper breast, while the lower breast, belly, and tail are rufous. The daggerlike bill is long, thin, and straight. Males have a white chin, the females buff. The chicks hatch with down, unlike most piciform birds. The rufous-tailed jacamar usually forms pairs or family groups, and perches upright on exposed twigs to wait for prey. Both the male and the female incubate the eggs and feed the young. This bird has a sharp call and a distinct loud song: an accelerating “pee-pee-pee” that ends in a trill.

*Bucco capensis*

Collared puffbird



Location N. South America

Length 8 1/2 in (21 cm)
Weight 2 oz (55 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern



Puffbirds comprise a family of about 32 species of dull-colored, small to medium-sized, sit-and-wait hunters. Most puffbirds hunt in treetops, and the larger species may catch small reptiles with their strong, hooked bills. The collared puffbird has an orange bill, brown upperparts, and whitish underparts with a large breastband. Its plumage is fluffy, and it has tiny feet. Inhabiting humid, lowland forests, it sits quietly most of the time; only the head moves occasionally as it scans the surroundings for prey. This behavior has earned it names like “sleeper.”

Chelidoptera tenebrosa

Swallow-winged puffbird



Location N. and C. South America

Length 7 in (18 cm)
Weight 1 1/4 oz (35 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern



The disproportionately long wings of the swallow-winged puffbird make it look like a bat or a large butterfly in flight. It is an excellent, almost acrobatic, flier and soarer. Black to dark gray, it sits more in the sun, and is easier to spot than other puffbirds. It sits and waits before sallying out to snatch prey on the wing, occasionally hovering in the process.

*Lybius dubius*

Bearded barbet



Location W. Africa

Length 10 in (25 cm)
Weight 2 1/2 – 4 oz (70 – 125 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern



Found in Asia, South America, and Africa, barbets are usually solidly built birds with gaudy plumage. Most have conspicuous bristles at the base of their bill—a feature that gives them their name. The bearded barbet has black upperparts and red underparts, with a

black breastband and white flanks. Its bill is large and powerful, and it feeds mainly on fruit, showing a particular liking for wild figs. It also gleans insects from bark.

*Psilopoon virens*

Great barbet

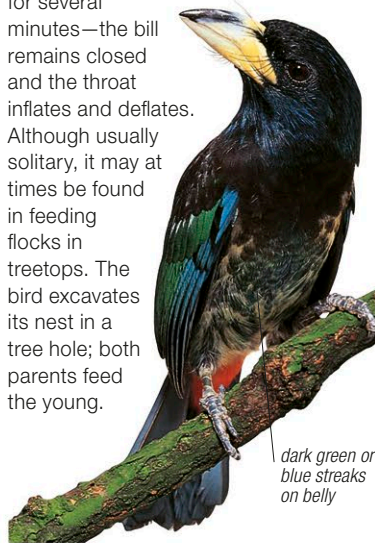


Location C., S.E., and E. Asia

Length 12 1/2 in (32 cm)
Weight 7 – 11 oz (200 – 300 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern



One of the largest barbets, this clumsy looking bird has a large, pale bill with numerous long bristles. Like other barbets, it often engages in dueting, the male and female singing alternate notes. While calling—a loud, musical sound that is repeated monotonously for several minutes—the bill remains closed and the throat inflates and deflates. Although usually solitary, it may at times be found in feeding flocks in treetops. The bird excavates its nest in a tree hole; both parents feed the young.



dark green or blue streaks on belly

Pogoniulus bilineatus

Yellow-rumped tinkerbird



Location W. to S.E. Africa

Length 4 in (10 cm)
Weight 7/16 oz (13 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern



white facial stripes

black bill

A wide-ranging African bird with many regional forms differing in pattern and color, the yellow-rumped tinkerbird has a metallic call consisting of a series of popping sounds. While calling, the bird sits upright, puffing up its throat and making its rump feathers erect. This tiny barbet moves rapidly through canopy, bushes, and vines, picking up fruit and insects. It occasionally hunts insects on the wing. Rather aggressive toward other small barbets, it defends its territory vigorously. Courtship appears to involve flutter flights.

Trachyphonus darnaudii

D'Arnaud's barbet



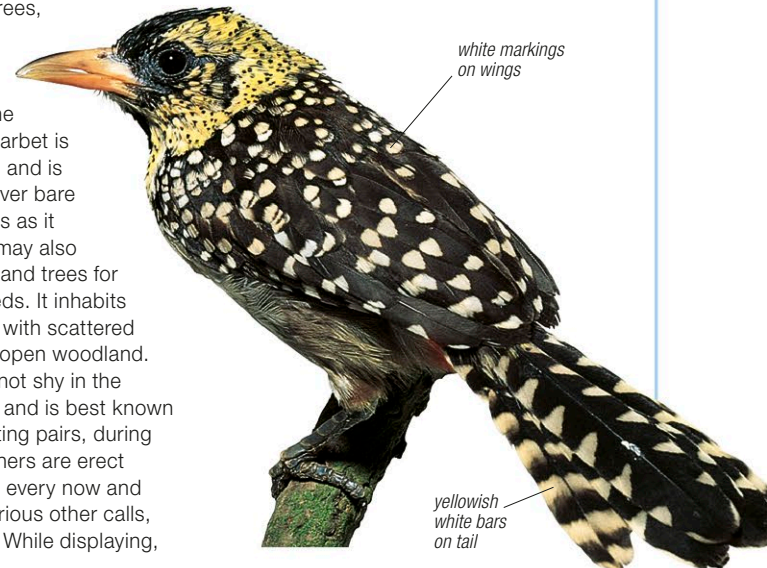
Location E. Africa

Length 8 in (20 cm)
Weight 1 1/16 oz (30 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern



Most barbets live in trees, but a small number—particularly in tropical Africa—are equally at home on the ground. D'Arnaud's barbet is one of these species, and is often seen hopping over bare earth or through grass as it searches for food. It may also forage in low bushes and trees for insects, fruit, and seeds. It inhabits flat terrain: grassland with scattered trees, bushland, and open woodland. D'Arnaud's barbet is not shy in the presence of humans, and is best known for the dueting of mating pairs, during which the crown feathers are erect and the tail is cocked every now and then. The bird has various other calls, including alarm calls. While displaying,

this yellow-orange, black, and red barbet spreads and swings its tail, bobs its head, and wipes its bill. It is a social bird, living in pairs or small family groups consisting of the breeding pair and subordinate individuals who may assist in raising the young. The mating pair defend their territory aggressively, marking the boundaries vocally by their duets. Both the male and female D'Arnaud's barbet dig the nest vertically into the ground, and line the nest chamber with grass.



white markings on wings

yellowish white bars on tail